Rites" 3 as the lead story and on the cover. Weird Tales was a fantasy magazine, not science fiction, and it had made its first appearance even before Amazing had. Weird Tales had had a colorful history, but it had been going downhill for a long time and had not much longer to live. This was the only time I ever appeared in it and I am rather glad, for sentimental reasons, that I managed to make it before the magazine died.

9

On June 25, 1950, North Korean forces invaded South Korea, the United States sent troops into Korea, and the Korean War had begun. I feared a repetition of all the miseries of World War II, but the Korean War was a minor squabble in comparison, and since I was over thirty by now, there was never any question of my being drafted.

Stanley was the one in danger now, for he would be twenty-one in a month and was just the right age. However, his eyes were worse than mine, and when he underwent his physical examination, they were listed as 20/600, which made him a 4F.

10

We went to New York on June 30 to attend a science-fiction conference. I showed up at 3:00 p.m. on July 1, just eleven years after the first convention I attended, but this time, of course, I was a big wheel.

8 See The Early Asimov.

Among those whom I now met for the first time were Poul Anderson, another one of Campbell's discoveries, whose first story was 'Tomorrow's Children" in the March 1947 Astounding; Jerome Bixby (then editor of Planet Stories); and Bea MahafTey (the editor of a new magazine, Other Worlds). Bea was a science-fiction editor who was not only a woman but also a young and beautiful woman at that.

The next day was the big day of the conference, with many speakers. It was my turn at 4:10 p.m. I spoke to an audience of 150, the largest I had ever had. Gertrude was brought in (rather against her will) by Roz Wylie. Gertrude sat in the last row, in agony over my possible embarrassment, just as on our honeymoon when she had sat in the balcony while I was competing in the quiz. After I had spoken for a while, I noticed she had changed seats and was now in the front row; she had apparently stopped worrying.